

# Martial Arts Lineages: A Chronological Reader

Original multi-page fixture covering grappling, striking, codification, and hybrid practice.

## Grappling before modern sport

Grappling appears in many early societies because it requires limited equipment and can be practiced with controlled intensity. Greek wrestling, Indian kushti, Mongolian wrestling, and Japanese jujutsu all show how body control became both training and public competition.

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## Boxing and rule making

Bare-knuckle boxing and later gloved boxing show a shift from challenge fighting toward regulated sport. The London Prize Ring Rules and the Queensberry Rules helped create rounds, fouls, gloves, and a clearer boundary between spectacle and uncontrolled violence.

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## Judo and educational reform

Jigoro Kano founded the Kodokan in Tokyo and framed judo as physical education, moral training, and practical technique. Judo preserved throwing and grappling methods while using randori to test skill under a safer structure.

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## Karate between Okinawa and Japan

Karate developed in Okinawa through local practice and outside influence, then changed as it entered schools and universities in mainland Japan. Gichin Funakoshi, Kenwa Mabuni, Choki Motobu, and others helped shape public karate identities.

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## Korean martial arts and taekwondo

Korean martial arts history includes indigenous games, Japanese colonial-era influence, military training, and postwar institution building. Taekwondo became globally recognizable through forms, sparring, national organizations, and Olympic sport.

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## Capoeira as movement and memory

Capoeira in Brazil joined music, ritual, play, and combat skill. Its history is tied to African diaspora communities, policing, urban life, and later cultural recognition. The roda preserved a social setting as much as a set of techniques.

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## Brazilian jiu-jitsu and ground fighting

Brazilian jiu-jitsu grew from judo and jujutsu influences that were adapted in Brazil. Teachers emphasized leverage, positional control, and submissions, eventually reshaping global conversations about ground fighting and self-defense.

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## Mixed martial arts and the feedback loop

Mixed martial arts created a public testing ground where striking, wrestling, clinch work, and submission grappling could be compared. It did not end traditional martial arts; it created a feedback loop in which traditions borrowed from sport and sport borrowed from tradition.

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